

Eleventh International Olympiad in Linguistics

Manchester (Great Britain), July 22–26, 2013

Individual Contest Solutions

Problem #2. The compound noun has the following structure:

$$\boxed{\begin{array}{c} \text{modifier} \\ (-l \text{ is lost}) \end{array}} + \left\{ \begin{array}{ll} -d- & (\text{before a vowel}) \\ -n- & (\text{before a consonant}) \end{array} \right\} + \boxed{\text{modified}}.$$

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|-----|--------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------|----------------|
| | <i>ilennime</i> | herd of deer (“house of deer”) | <i>møŋer</i> | thunder |
| | <i>joqonnime</i> | wooden house (“Yakut house”) | <i>ciremennime</i> | nest |
| | <i>saanchoje</i> | wooden knife | <i>joqonchoje</i> | Yakut knife |
| | <i>johudawur</i> | nose case | <i>saadoŋoj</i> | wooden box |
| (a) | <i>ilenlegul</i> | deer feed | <i>uoduo</i> | grandchild |
| | <i>cireme</i> | bird | <i>oŋoj</i> | bag |
| | <i>johul</i> | nose | <i>aariinjohul</i> | rifle’s muzzle |
| | <i>aariinmøŋer</i> | gunshot (“rifle thunder”) | <i>uodawur</i> | cradle |
| | <i>joqodile</i> | horse (“Yakut deer”) | <i>joqol</i> | Yakut person |
- (b) *aarii* — rifle, *aariidoŋoj* — rifle case, *ciremedawur* — nest (= *ciremennime*), *ile* — deer, *johudewce* — tip of nose, *legul* — food, *saal* — wood, *saannime* — wooden house (= *joqonnime*), *uo* — child.
- (c) iron bird — *cuoncireme*, snoring — *johunmøŋer*, tip of knife’s blade — *cho-jedewce*, sack for provisions — *legudoŋoj*.